INSTRUCTIONAL AREA
Market Planning

RETAIL MERCHANDISING SERIES EVENT

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- "This event is presented to you through your review of the Career Competencies, Performance Indicators and Event Situation."
- "You have up to 10 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. Using the materials provided, you may make notes to use during your presentation."
- "You will have up to 10 minutes to present to the judge(s)."
- "You will be evaluated on your solution to the event situation, how you incorporate the performance indicators of this event and how you demonstrate the career competencies."
- "Turn in all your notes and event materials when you have completed the event."

SOLUTION

- Unique – Demonstrate original thinking, fresh perspectives and an insightful approach.
- Practical – Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.
- Effective – Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes.

CAREER COMPETENCIES

- Critical Thinking – Think critically to understand and solve problems.
- Communication – Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.
- Decision Making – Consider the impacts of decisions.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Explain the nature of marketing planning.
2. Identify ways to segment markets for marketing communications.
3. Explain the nature of sales forecasts.
4. Explain the concept of product mix.
5. Describe word-of-mouth channels used to communicate with targeted audiences.

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the role of a store manager for THREADLINE, a clothing retailer with two stores that sells trendy apparel to teens and young adults. The owner (judge) wants your advice on whether to add a resale section to both stores.

For six weeks, THREADLINE tested a small section of gently used, brand-name clothing at one of its stores. Customers sold or traded in their used items, and THREADLINE resold them. Here are the results:

- 400 resale items sold in six weeks
- 61% of resale buyers were new THREADLINE customers
- The average resale item sold for $18, compared with $42 for new items
- THREADLINE earned a higher profit percentage on resale items than on new items

The owner (judge) is excited but worried. Some loyal customers have asked if THREADLINE is “becoming a thrift store.” The owner (judge) also doesn’t know how many resale items to stock if the section expands to both stores.

The owner (judge) wants you to:

- Explain what marketing planning is and why it’s needed before expanding the resale section.
- Identify the customer segments that would be interested in resale clothing and how to reach each one.
- Explain how THREADLINE could forecast resale sales for both stores.
- Explain how adding resale clothing would change THREADLINE’s product mix.
- Describe word-of-mouth channels THREADLINE could use to spread the news about the resale section.

You will present your ideas to the owner (judge) in a meeting at the store. The owner (judge) will begin the meeting by greeting you and asking to hear your ideas. After you have presented your ideas and answered the owner’s (judge’s) questions, the owner (judge) will conclude the meeting by thanking you for your work.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. How do we answer customers who think we're turning into a thrift store?
2. Which word-of-mouth channel would reach the most new customers for the least money?

	Rate the participant's ability to:	Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Explain the nature of marketing planning.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
2.	Identify ways to segment markets for marketing communications.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
3.	Explain the nature of sales forecasts.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
4.	Explain the concept of product mix.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
5.	Describe word-of-mouth channels used to communicate with targeted audiences.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
SOLUTION						
4.	**Unique** Demonstrate original thinking, fresh perspectives and an insightful approach.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
5.	**Practical** Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
6.	**Effective** Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAEREER COMPETANCIES						
7.	**Critical Thinking** Think critically to understand and solve problems	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
8.	**Communication** Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
9.	**Decision Making** Consider the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSIONS						
10.	Demonstrate overall career readiness through professionalism, poise and confidence.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
					TOTAL SCORE	